

Lawhive · Hackathon 2026



CASE BRIEF / FRESH

CASE 02

OUR WEDDING PHOTOGRAPHER DIDN'T SHOW UP

V. 01

LONDON 30/05/26

FRESH



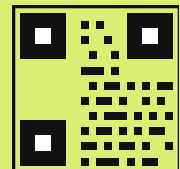
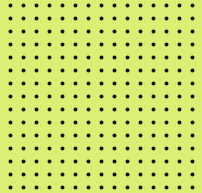
CLAIMANT

Sarah and Tom Mitchell

Early 30s, Bristol



SPONSORED BY ANTHROP\\C · Google Cloud · Balderton.



Our wedding photographer didn't show up

Sarah and Tom Mitchell, Early 30s, Bristol

PROBLEM, IN THE CLIENT'S OWN WORDS

We got married just over two months ago and our photographer didn't turn up. We're devastated.

We booked her about 18 months before the wedding through Instagram, she runs her business through her page. We paid a £500 deposit when we booked and the remaining £2,000 about eight weeks before the wedding, so £2,500 in total. She did do a pre-wedding shoot for us about two months before the big day which cost an extra £300 (paid separately), and we were happy with those photos, so we had no reason to think anything was wrong.

On the morning of the wedding she just didn't show up. No message, no call, nothing. My mum tried calling her and it rang out. We've sent messages on Instagram, WhatsApp and email since then, nothing. She hasn't even read the messages.

A friend stepped in and took photos on their phone which was kind of them, but it's obviously not the same as professional photography. We want our £2,500 back. We also feel like we should be compensated for the distress, we can never get those moments back.

Her T&Cs mention something about force majeure which I'm worried about, what if she tries to use that as an excuse?

KEY INFORMATION

Claimants	Sarah Mitchell and Tom Mitchell
Address	14 Larkspur Avenue, Bristol BS6 7DH
Photographer	Holly Marsh, trading as Holly Vale
Wedding date	21 March 2026
Total paid	£2,500 (plus £300 pre-wedding shoot)

DOCUMENTS PROVIDED

#	FILENAME	DESCRIPTION
01	booking_confirmation_dms.pdf	Screenshots of the original Instagram DM conversation where Sarah agreed the booking, including dates, package details and confirmation of availability.
02	invoice_and_tcs.pdf	PDF invoice for £2,500 full-day wedding coverage. Attached T&Cs include a force majeure clause, cancellation policy, and a liability cap to 'the total fee paid'.
03	payment_proof_deposit.png	Bank transfer confirmation for the £500 deposit.
04	payment_proof_balance.png	Bank transfer confirmation for the £2,000 balance payment.

#	FILENAME	DESCRIPTION
05	payment_proof_prewedding.png	Separate bank transfer confirmation for the £300 pre-wedding shoot.
06	unanswered_messages.pdf	Compiled screenshots of unanswered Instagram DMs, WhatsApp messages and email sent over six weeks since the wedding. All delivered, none read.